

by French forces in the Napoleonic Wars.

“ **God** has bestowed **a talent** upon me and
I thank him for it. ”

JOSEPH HAYDN, c. 1800



VIENNA BOMBARDED

During Haydn's terminal illness in May 1809, French troops besieging Vienna bombarded the district where he lived with explosive shells. By the time the composer died on the last day of the month, the French had occupied the city.